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CF Private Equity
Real Assets & Sustainability Team
601 Merritt 7
Norwalk, CT 06851

Dear Real Assets & Sustainability Team,

I am applying for the 2027 Private Equity Analyst role on the Real Assets and Sustainability team. I am currently pursuing an MS in Finance and Investment Management at Sacred Heart University in Fairfield, a short drive from your Norwalk office, and I hold a BS in Computer Science with a 3.8 GPA. You asked why real assets and sustainability specifically, so I will answer directly. My first serious exposure to markets came through futures contracts, the place where oil, natural gas, corn, and metals are priced every day. I spent three years building software around those markets, and the longer I spent there, the more I wanted to understand the physical businesses underneath the prices: who builds the power generation, who owns the farmland and water, and who makes the capital decisions that determine whether those assets earn a return. The sustainability side of your platform adds the question I find most interesting: how to earn standalone private equity returns while the environmental benefit is measured rather than assumed.

You also asked for the most relevant experience I would bring. From 2022 to 2025 I taught myself MQL5 and NinjaScript and designed algorithmic trading tools for futures markets. I then built software that generates futures trading strategies, marketed it myself, and sold packages to roughly five clients, producing four-figure revenue. I also did contract work converting clients' manual trading strategies into automated algorithms, which meant extracting the exact logic behind each client's decisions and encoding it precisely enough that a machine could execute it without error. That is the discipline I would bring to diligence: pull the real drivers out of a business, test whether they hold, and write them down clearly enough that an Investment Committee can rely on them. During my internship at Edward Jones I researched investment strategies for senior management and validated client records. I am proficient in Python, which I would use to speed up data gathering and portfolio monitoring.

My experience is less conventional than the banking or consulting path you describe, and I would rather say that plainly than overstate it. What I offer instead is a record of working autonomously and finishing. I founded Rodriguez Pressure Washing LLC and have run every part of it since 2023, from knocking on more than 1,000 doors to scheduling, buying and maintaining equipment, and keeping customers coming back. Playing D1 soccer for a team ranked third nationally in the NAIA, and earning the Champions of Character Award, taught me to prepare thoroughly, hold a high standard under pressure, and put the team's goal ahead of my own. I am also bilingual in Spanish.

I am hardworking, I learn fast, and I take real pride in getting things right the first time. I would welcome the chance to talk about how I can contribute to the Real Assets and Sustainability team's diligence and research work. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Diego Rodriguez